

No one knows what the future will bring

The future is inherently unknown and unknowable (pardon the repetition, but it bears repeating). Occasionally, some people get small glimpses of it. Jobs gets credit for recognizing the value of the graphic user interface, of making complex technology easy to use, of putting all of the power of a desktop computer into a touch screen on a mobile device. Woz, to a lesser degree, gets credit for reducing the impossible to an engineering problem. But in 1976, nobody but nobody thought Apple would become the world's largest company a few decades later, and completely change the world.

Make sure your risk tolerance aligns with your actions

Wayne was in his 40s when he joined the Steves; he had other life experience, including prior businesses that had gone belly-up. He understood the legal risks of a partnership—including joint and several liability, which holds each partner personally responsible for debt incurred by the partnership.

His risk tolerance was not a good match for this venture.

Wayne had become friendly with Jobs when they were working at Atari. Given the youthful inexperience of his partners—and recognizing that Jobs embraced risk with reckless abandon—Wayne ultimately thought the better of having to deal with the fallout if the venture crashed and burned, which is so often the outcome for any start-up.

He was also the *adult supervision*. Whether it was the risk of the partnership structure or concern about simply trying to keep up with two 20-somethings, this was not the right fit for him.

A good lawyer is worth his weight in gold

Setting up Apple as a partnership—and not Apple Inc.—was the fastest and